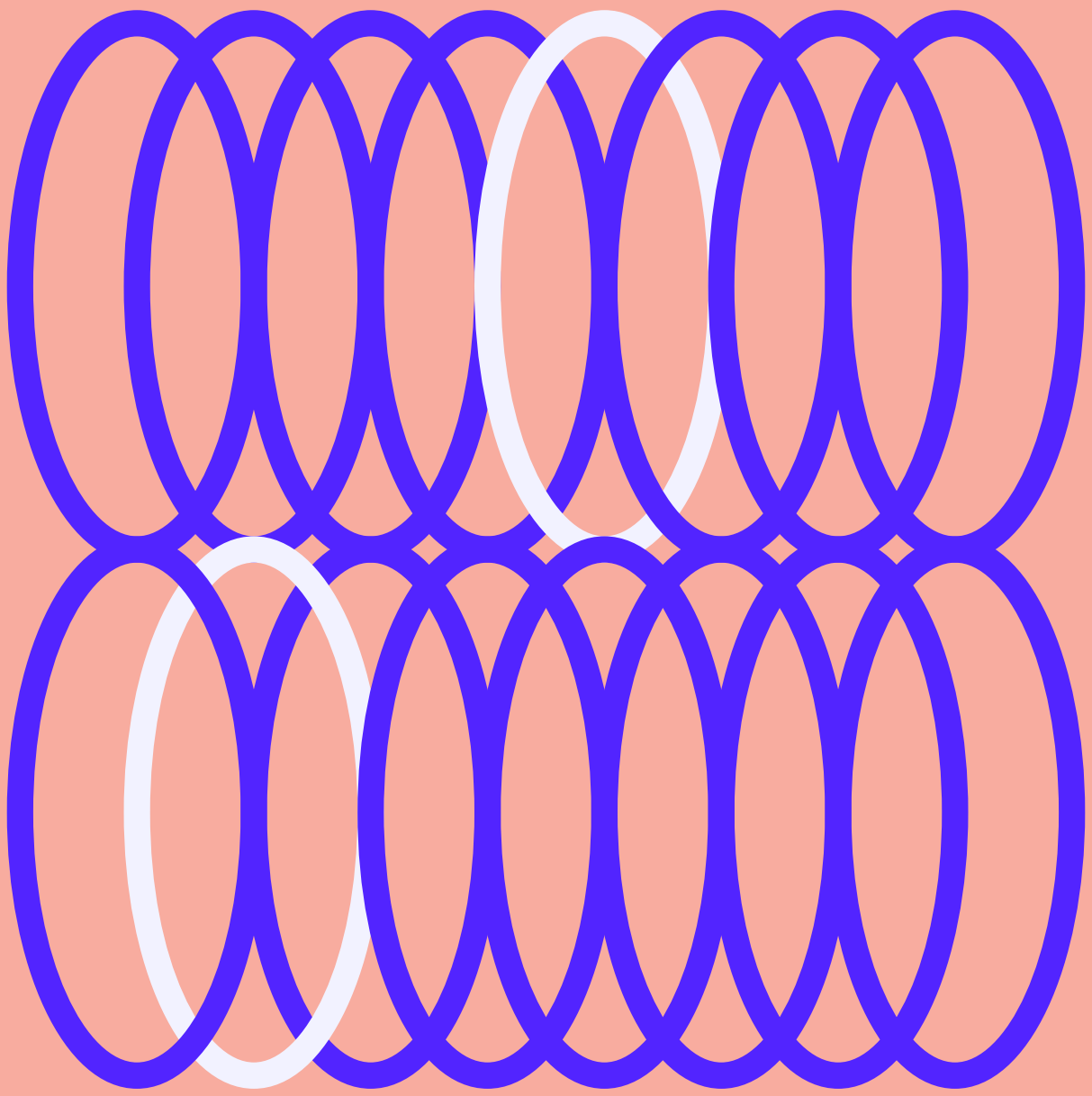
SiteScanly

The Monthly Website Maintenance Routine for Busy Owners



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Introduction

Your website is part of your business, even when you are not working. It reassures new customers, answers common questions, and turns interest into enquiries, bookings, or sales. When something goes wrong, it is rarely dramatic. It is usually quiet: a form that stops sending, a page that loads slowly on a phone, or a button that does nothing.

This ebook gives you a calm monthly routine you can repeat in about 30 minutes. You do not need to be technical. You do not need lots of tools. You just need a consistent habit that helps you spot small problems before they cost you time, money, or confidence.

In this guide, we will cover:

01 The calm mindset

02 Set up once

03 Trust and safety

04 Speed and mobile feel

05 Broken journeys

06 Findability basics

07 Prioritisation

08 The calm monthly checklist

01

The calm mindset

A monthly routine is not about being 'techy'. It is about staying in control. Most website stress comes from one feeling: 'I do not know if things are working'. This routine replaces that uncertainty with a simple check and a short plan. It also keeps you out of the trap of tinkering constantly. You are checking the basics that customers rely on, then getting back to running your business.

Use the three-bucket rule. Every issue you notice goes into one bucket:

- 'Urgent' (do soon): it blocks enquiries, looks broken, or damages trust.
- 'Important' (schedule it): it reduces performance or clarity, but customers can still use the site.
- 'Nice to have' (leave it): it would be better, but it is not affecting real customers right now.

Common examples of 'urgent':

- The contact form errors or never confirms sending
- A booking button does nothing
- A page fails to load on mobile

Common examples of 'important':

- Pages feel slow on a phone
- The Home page does not quickly explain what you do
- Images look fuzzy, stretched, or oversized

The rule that keeps it calm:

At the end of your monthly check, choose only three actions:

1. One urgent fix (if needed)
2. One important improvement
3. One thing to ignore on purpose

Mindset check

- [ ] I will focus on what matters to customers
- [ ] I will only pick three actions this month
- [ ] I will treat a 'boring' check as a win
- [ ] I will timebox the routine to 30 minutes

02

Set up once (10 minutes)

This routine works best when you remove decisions. Do the setup once, then repeat the same steps every month. The aim is to make it easy to start, even on a busy day.

What to do

1. Choose your monthly time slot
   Pick a date you can usually manage and protect it. Many owners choose the first Monday or the last Friday of the month. Set a 30-minute reminder called 'Website check'.
2. Create a simple 'Website notes' document
   Use a phone note, notebook, or document. Each month, record: What you checked. What you noticed. What you decided to do next.
3. Pick your three key pages
   These are the pages that make or break enquiries. For most businesses it is Home, Services, Contact and, if you sell items, the Product page.
4. Decide how you will test enquiries
   Choose one method you will repeat each month
5. Make sure you can see the result
   Check you have access to key places that would hold your results. For instances, your email inbox that receives enquires, your bookings dashboard and your order notifications (if relevant).

Optional but helpful:

- Save your three key pages as bookmarks on your phone
- Note who to contact if something breaks (name, email, or number)

Quick checklist

- [ ] Calendar reminder set
- [ ] Notes document created
- [ ] Three key pages chosen
- [ ] Test enquiry method decided
- [ ] Enquiry inbox accessible
- [ ] Bookmarks saved (optional)

03

Trust and safety (5 minutes)

This step is about first impressions. If your website looks broken, suspicious, or inconsistent, people hesitate. Hesitation often means no enquiry. Start on your phone. If you can, use mobile data rather than Wi-Fi. This is closer to how customers browse, and it helps you spot problems that only happen outside your own network.

Quick checks:

- Does the site load within a few seconds?
- Does the layout look normal on mobile?
- Do images load, or are there blank spaces?
- Are there pop-ups that feel unexpected?
- Do you see any browser warnings?

Treat this as 'urgent' if you notice:

- A security warning in the browser
- Pages failing to load
- Strange redirects to other sites
- A banner or pop-up that blocks the page and cannot be closed
- The site looks very different to last month, with no obvious reason

What to do next:

Do not diagnose. Write one clear sentence and move on to the next step. If you are unsure, check the same page on a second device, or ask someone you trust to open it on their phone.

Quick checklist

- [ ] Checked on mobile
- [ ] No warnings seen
- [ ] Key pages load
- [ ] Contact details visible
- [ ] Any issue noted in one sentence

04

Speed and mobile feel (10 minutes)

Speed affects patience. On mobile, people decide quickly whether to stay or leave. A slow page can feel like a broken page, even if it eventually loads. It can also make your business feel less trustworthy, even when your service is excellent.

Part A: the 'human' check (3 minutes)

Your Home page

1. Your Home page
2. A key Services page (or a key product page)
3. Do they feel quick enough?
4. Does the page jump around while loading?

Part B: the 'measurement' check (7 minutes)

Run one key page through a speed test (any reputable tool is fine). Record:

1. The page tested
2. The result as 'good', 'average', or 'poor'
3. Any obvious issue mentioned (for example, very large images)

Treat this as 'urgent' if:

- The page takes so long you would personally give up

Treat this as 'important' if:

- The page works, but feels heavy or clunky
- The tool mentions large images, too many scripts, or unused features

Quick checklist

- [ ] Replace one oversized image with a smaller version
- [ ] Remove or shorten an autoplay video
- [ ] Reduce pop-ups, sliders, or animation effects
- [ ] Simplify a heavy page with fewer sections
- [ ] Ask for basic speed tidy-up (if you have support)
- [ ] Result saved in notes

05

Broken journeys (10 minutes)

This is the most valuable step because it is directly linked to income. A website can look fine, but still fail at the moment someone tries to contact you, book you, or buy from you. Breaks often happen after small changes: a theme update, a form setting, an email rule, or an added feature. Sometimes nothing is broken on the website itself, but the message ends up in the wrong inbox, or a confirmation email never arrives.

Start with your three key pages:

- Home
- Services (or key product page)
- Contact (or bookings)

Click-through checklist:

- [ ] Click each main menu item
- [ ] Click your main call-to-action button
- [ ] Open the Contact page
- [ ] Check phone number and email address are correct
- [ ] Send a test message (best option)
- [ ] Confirm the test message arrives in your inbox

Treat this as 'urgent' if:

- A key button does nothing
- The contact form errors or never confirms sending
- Bookings or payments cannot be completed
- Your test message never arrives

What to write in your notes:

- Page
- What you clicked
- What happened

06

Findability basics (5 minutes)

This step is not about becoming an SEO expert. It is about making sure your website is clear to a stranger. Clarity helps people decide to contact you, and it also helps search engines understand your pages. Choose one key page to review. Most owners choose the Home page or the main Services page.

Open the page and ask:

1. Would someone new understand what I do in 10 seconds?
2. Who is this for?
3. What should they do next?
4. Does it feel specific, or a bit vague?

Search your business name online and look at the first result. Ask:

- Does the page title look sensible?
- Does the short description sound like your business?
- If it looks odd, outdated, or confusing, note it as important.

Common clarity fixes

- [ ] Replace vague phrases like 'solutions' with real services
- [ ] Make the main button clearer (for example, 'Request a quote')
- [ ] Add one proof point near the top (a short testimonial is enough)
- [ ] Break long paragraphs into shorter ones with subheadings

Quick outdated details check:

- [ ] Opening hours
- [ ] Phone number and email address
- [ ] Pricing, if shown
- [ ] Services you no longer offer

If you serve a local area, make it obvious. A small line like 'Serving Exeter and nearby' helps people feel confident they have found the right business.

07

The 60-second prioritisation test

After your checks, you will usually find one or two small issues. Sometimes you will find nothing. Both are normal. This page stops you turning a small finding into a stressful project.

Ask three questions:

1. Does it stop people enquiring, booking, or buying?
2. Does it damage trust? (warnings, broken pages, odd behaviour)
3. Does it reduce clarity? (unclear wording, confusing layout, missing details)

Decide the bucket:

- If it blocks money or trust, it is 'urgent'.
- If it reduces effectiveness but the site still works, it is 'important'.
- If it is cosmetic, it is 'nice to have'.

Do now (one quick win you can handle):

- [ ] Fix one broken link you can find
- [ ] Correct one wrong detail (hours, phone, email)
- [ ] Improve one unclear sentence near the top of a key page

Schedule or delegate (one thing to line up):

- [ ] Contact form or booking issue
- [ ] Speed improvement that needs technical changes
- [ ] Anything involving hosting, email delivery, or certificates

Ignore on purpose (one thing to leave):

- [ ] Minor design tweaks
- [ ] Rewriting entire pages
- [ ] Anything you would not notice as a customer

08

The calm monthly checklist

Use this page each month. Print it, copy it into a note, or keep it as a simple template. The aim is not to do everything. The aim is to do the basics consistently.

Two rules:

- If you find an 'urgent' issue, prioritise it before anything else.
- If everything is fine, celebrate the boring result and move on.

Step 1: Trust and safety (5 mins)

- [ ] Site loads on mobile
- [ ] No warnings or strange pop-ups
- [ ] Layout looks normal (no missing images)
- [ ] Contact details easy to find

Step 2: Speed and mobile feel (10 mins)

- [ ] Home page feels 'quick enough'
- [ ] One key page tested for speed
- [ ] Any obvious cause noted (for example, large images)

Step 3: Broken journeys (10 mins)

- [ ] Main menu links work
- [ ] Main buttons work
- [ ] Contact form loads and can be submitted
- [ ] Test message arrived in inbox
- [ ] Bookings or checkout tested (if relevant)

Step 4: Findability basics (5 mins)

- [ ] Home or Services page is clear in 10 seconds
- [ ] Search result looks sensible for business name
- [ ] One clarity improvement identified (or 'all clear')

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